BJP'S DOUBLE ENGINE DESERT BLITZ PG 9

# UPFRONT

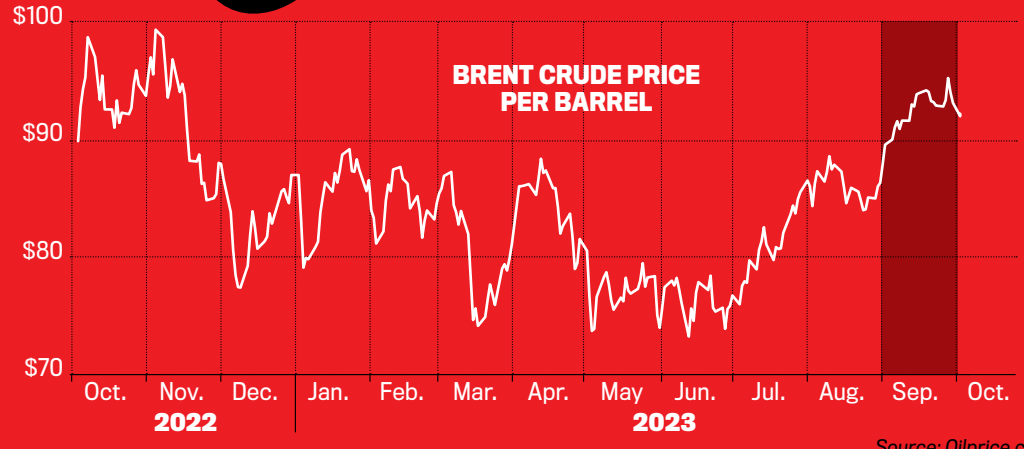
PUNJAB: ALLIANCE HITS VIGILANCE BUMP PG 12



*Illustration by* TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

## THE OIL PRICE RALLY

***Oil prices have seen a 14 per cent spike in the past one month***




*Source: Oilprice.com*

OIL PRICES

# CRUDE SHOCK

By M.G. Arun

A rising trend of crude oil prices has once again come to haunt the country, threatening to widen the current account deficit (CAD), weaken the rupee and further stoke inflation. CAD refers to the situation where the total value of goods and services India imports exceeds the total value of its exports. Crude oil prices in the global market rose to 10-month highs in the past few weeks as large producers like Russia and Saudi Arabia cut supply, and reserves of fuel and crude remained low. This has led to the price of the benchmark Brent crude rising